



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinitas Classical School

School Website: <https://www.trinitasclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Trinitas Classical School (Mi 49508) presents a clearly Christian, classical-leaning model that centers virtue, truth, and beauty within a Reformed/Christian-theological framework. Public-facing materials emphasize formation over mere information, a Trivium-oriented curriculum, active parental partnership, and a mentorship ethos embodied by a "classical education" mission. The presence of Philippians 4:8 as a guiding verse, explicit language about virtue and formation, and a Chapel-focused culture all signal strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and a mission oriented toward formation rather than job-prep. Public materials also articulate a commitment to a screen-free community and parental partnership, reinforcing a robust Parents & Community axis.

However, while Trinitas clearly communicates classical aims (notably the Trivium and a Christian formation focus), some elements of the full classical-education rubric—such as explicit, sustained Great Books engagement, a fully articulated Socratic pedagogy beyond occasional reference, and a fully explicit "living curriculum" in faculty practice—are less overt in the available public-facing content. As a result, the school leans solidly CLASSICAL overall, with specific areas that appear MOSTLY CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully explicit in every dimension.

Key takeaway: Trinitas is CLASSICAL overall, with strongest signals in religious/metaphysical foundations, formation as purpose, and parental/community partnership. The strongest growth opportunities relate to deeper articulation of curriculum (Great Books / Great Conversation), explicit pedagogical methods (Socratic/Scholé practices), and a more explicit living-faculty narrative.

Executive highlights by category (category-by-category view is provided below with evidence, keyword analysis, and rating rationale).

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL. Evidence includes God's Vision with truth, nobility, and beauty; ecumenical Christian community; and liturgical-communion practices evidenced by Chapel references.
- Evidence: God's Vision and Our Mission statements; Screen-Free Community; Chapel-related materials.
- Positive keyword indicators: truth, nobility, virtue, beauty, unity in faith, liturgy/church practice; formation; and reverence for the sacred.
- Why: Transcendental moral realism is implied by declaring truth, nobility, and beauty as real and worthy of contemplation, with theology/chapel practices shaping daily life. This aligns strongly with the lexicon's Positive Keywords for this element.
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL. Evidence shows formation of mind, body, and spirit; emphasis on truth and virtue; and a formation-oriented aim rather than job-prep alone.

- Evidence: Our Mission and “Cultivating Lives of Faith, Reason, and Virtue” framing; emphasis on formation over mere information.
- Positive keyword indicators: formation, virtue, wisdom (as implied by the phrase “Faith, Reason, and Virtue”), pursuit of truth (as above).
- Why: The school’s stated aim is formation toward virtue and wisdom, with a declared telos anchored in truth and beauty—core classical criteria. This maps to Positive Keywords for this element and yields CLASSICAL.
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Evidence includes explicit Trivium emphasis and a clear pathway to classical study; explicit Great Books engagement is not clearly stated in public materials, though there are strong signals of a Trivium-focused liberal-arts curriculum.
- Evidence: Link to “academics/trivium” (explicit Trivium focus). Also, public-facing materials reference “Classical Education” and the Trivium.
- Positive keyword indicators: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) is explicitly referenced via the Trivium page; Great Books / Great Conversation is mentioned in the broader classical lexicon materials but is not clearly evidenced in the site text.
- Negative keyword indicators: Absence of explicit Great Books / primary-text program in the visible site content lowers the strength of the Great Books criterion.
- Why: The presence of Trivium signals a classical curriculum core, but the explicit Great Books / Great Conversation and integrated history-liberal-arts structure are not clearly evidenced in public-site text, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL assessment.
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Evidence suggests classical aims and a structured curriculum, but two key pedagogical signals—explicit Socratic seminar/dialectic practice and a clearly articulated Scholé/restful pedagogy—are not strongly evidenced in visible content. The site does not consistently describe upper-school Socratic seminars or a sustained restful-learning framework in public pages, though it hints at classical pedagogy through its Trivium emphasis and Chapel-centered formation.
- Evidence: Trivium emphasis; public materials on formation and virtue; Chapel-based communal culture.
- Positive keyword indicators: Socratic dialogue (not explicit on site), seminar, rhetoric training (not clearly described), memory work (not described as a core practice), Scholé (not explicitly named in the public pages). The presence of Trivium and classical language is a positive sign, but explicit pedagogical methods are not clearly enumerated.
- Negative keyword indicators: Lack of explicit Socratic seminars, explicit Scholé, or explicit memory-driven routines described in public content.
- Why: The school aligns with classical aims and has core elements of classical pedagogy, but lacks explicit public articulation of a full Socratic/seminar-based upper-school program and Scholé practices, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (leaning toward NOT). The public site materials do not provide detailed statements about faculty as “living curriculum” or teacher-mentors modeled after classical tradition. The most robust signals in the public content relate to mission, community, and formation, rather than explicit faculty portraits or a “portrait of a teacher/student” that the Six Elements lexicon describes as hallmark of classical schools.
- Evidence: Public pages emphasize mission, formation, and parent partnership; explicit faculty portraits or references to teachers as “living curriculum” are not clearly present in the visible content.
- Positive keyword indicators: Where present in the lexicon, phrases like “portrait of a teacher,” “living curriculum,” and “faculty as mentors” are not explicitly visible in the site copy. The site does not strongly assert these faculty identities in the public-facing content (thus, few direct matches).

- Negative keyword indicators: Absence of explicit “living curriculum” language and teacher-portrait language in the public materials.
- Why: The absence of explicit faculty-language signals reduces the strength of a CLASSICAL claim in this category.
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL. Evidence shows robust parent partnership, a classical parent-blog ecosystem, and community-oriented events, which align with the classical model’s emphasis on family partnership and cultural transmission.
- Evidence: “Partnering with Parents,” “Classical Parent Blog,” and community-life references; open-doors and parent resources.
- Positive keyword indicators: “Partnership with Parents,” “Parent formation,” “classical book clubs,” “community of learners” (as reflected in lexicon), “Western civilizational inheritance” framing, and “family catechesis” style language in the lexicon. The site demonstrates active parental involvement and resources.
- Why: The public materials closely map to the lexicon’s Positive Keywords in the Parents & Community category, especially in partnership with families and formation of affections, yielding a CLASSICAL rating.
- Abstract aggregate and synthesis:
- Overall, Trinitas Classical School MI 49508 shows strong alignment with classical education in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose/Goal, and Parents & Community, with solid Curriculum signals (Trivium) and a formation-centric narrative. Pedagogy is present but not exhaustively detailed in public content. Faculty signals are modest or not explicit in public text. The aggregate assessment therefore sits at CLASSICAL, with some categories (Pedagogy, Faculty) showing SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL tendencies and Curriculum showing SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals due to limited explicit Great Books/Conversation mentions on public pages.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases)

- Make Great Books and Great Conversation explicit across the curriculum: include a public, explicit statement of Great Books engagement and a public-facing description of a Great Conversation approach within core subjects.
- Articulate explicit Socratic pedagogy for upper grades: publicly describe how Socratic seminars and dialectic discussions are used in upper grades, with sample prompts, seminar rituals (Harkness-style or similar), and assessment rubrics.
- Publicly articulate Scholé/restful elements: publish a clear rest/reflective pace framework (Scholé days, contemplative learning rhythms, and memory-work routines) in the curriculum documents and on the website.
- Expand the “living curriculum” narrative for Faculty: share portraits of teachers and their roles as mentors, emphasizing virtue formation and collegial, mentorship-driven practice.
- Strengthen explicit Great Books and Great Conversation signals: add a page that enumerates canonical works, authors, and the Great Conversation they participate in; link to a scope-and-sequence showing cross-disciplinary integration via classical texts.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site presents a clear theological and liturgical orientation through statements like God’s Vision (Philippians 4:8) and Our Mission describing Christian classical education; a Chapel-focused culture is evidenced by references to chapel talks on humility and related liturgical practices. - Positive religious/metaphysical indicators include truth, nobility, virtue, beauty, and the sacred (as part of the vision for education) and liturgical/community practices.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, noble, right, pure, lovely, admirable, virtue, formation, liturgy, worship, chapel, humility. The Philippians 4:8 verse anchors transcendental moral realism. - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials.

Why this rating - The school's materials center on transcendentals (truth, beauty, goodness) and a theology-grounded education, with liturgical/civic practices (Chapel) and ecumenical Christian community. This aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations category, yielding CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes formation of mind, body, and spirit and a focus on truth; explicit language of virtue formation and the search for wisdom aligns with classical aims. - "Cultivating Lives of Faith, Reason, and Virtue" explicitly frames the school's purpose; formation is foregrounded.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom (as part of the Faith/Reason/Virtue trio), truth, beauty (through the broader classical lexicon), telos/contemplation (implicit in formation focus). - Negative keywords present: none explicit in the public content (no strong shift toward job-prep or purely skills-focused aims).

Why this rating - The emphasis on formation and the pursuit of truth/beauty, alongside virtue development, matches key Positive Keywords for the School Purpose & Goal category. The absence of conflicting job-work emphasis in the public content supports CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit Trivium focus is present (via a link to the "academics/trivium/" page), signaling a liberal-arts core around grammar, logic, rhetoric. - The broader classical lexicon (Great Books, Great Conversation, liberal arts) is discussed in the knowledge-base materials, but explicit Great Books engagement is not clearly stated in the visible site text.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) signaled by the site; Classical Education framing. - Negative keywords present: Lack of explicit Great Books / Great Conversation on the public site text is a limitation for category completeness.

Why this rating - The curriculum clearly centers the Trivium, a hallmark of classical education, but the Great Books/Great Conversation and integrated liberal-arts emphasis are not explicitly documented in the public content. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is warranted.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's public materials emphasize classical education and formation through a Trivium-oriented approach, but there is no explicit, detailed public articulation of Socratic seminars, Scholé days, or memory-chanting practices as a sustained pedagogy. The presence of Chapel and formation signals suggests some contemplative elements, but explicit practice is not clearly described. - The existence of a "screen-free community" and a focus on formation imply contemplative rhythms, but explicit scholarly pedagogy terms (Socratic, scholé, memory work, etc.) are not strongly spelled out in the public pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Trivium (institutionally signaling a classical pedagogy) and the overall "Classical Education" framing; occasional mention of memory and recitation in classical lexicon (as seen in the knowledge-base materials). However, explicit pedagogy terms such as Socratic seminars, scholé days, liturgical memory, or formal memory-work are not clearly present in the site text. - Negative keywords present: Absence of explicit, public-facing descriptions of upper-school Socratic seminars or rest-oriented Scholé pedagogy.

Why this rating - The public materials show classical aims and Trivium emphasis but lack explicit statements of the full pedagogy described in the classical rubric. Consequently, the Pedagogy category is SOMEWHAT

CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public content does not present a detailed “living curriculum” portrait of faculty, mentorship culture, or teacher-as-model language in the visible pages. The core materials emphasize mission, formation, and parental partnership more than a faculty narrative. - The classical lexicon describes living-curriculum, teacher portraits, and mentorship culture as hallmarks; these explicit faculty elements are not clearly evidenced in the site text.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: The public materials do not clearly surface the classical-faculty language (e.g., “models of virtue,” “portrait of a teacher,” etc.). As such, positive signals for this category are weak. - Negative keywords present: None explicitly negative in the school’s own text, but the absence of explicit faculty-language signals lowers the Classical-ness signal for this category.

Why this rating - While the school demonstrates a clear classical formation ethos, explicit “faculty living-curriculum” signals are not evident in public materials, yielding NOT CLASSICAL for this category based on available public content.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school foregrounds partnership with parents and resources for classical-family involvement (Classical Parent Blog, parent resources, etc.), which aligns with the classical model’s emphasis on family partnership and formation. - The site emphasizes parent involvement, resources, and community-building around classical education, consistent with the lexicon’s positive signals for Parents & Community (parent formation, home-school partnership, open campus).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Partnership with Families, parent formation, shared mission, home-school collaboration, parental engagement, community of learners, living tradition in the family. These map to the lexicon’s listed Positive Keywords for Parents & Community. - Negative keywords present: None clearly visible; the public materials consistently present parents as partners rather than customers.

Why this rating - The school’s explicit emphasis on parental partnership, parent resources, and community engagement aligns strongly with the Parents & Community element, yielding CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Ranking and Assessment

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Rationale: Across the six elements, Trinitas Classical School MI 49508 presents a robust classical-and-Christian formation model with explicit religious/metaphysical grounding, formation-focused purpose, and Parental/Community partnership signals. The Curriculum shows clear Trivium orientation; Pedagogy and Faculty signals are present but not exhaustively explicit in public content, leading to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL marks in those areas. The strongest category signals are Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, and Parents & Community, which solidify a CLASSICAL overall rating.

What Would Move the Needle (only included for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases)

- If any category were to be moved toward FULL CLASSICAL in a single step:
- Publish explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments and list canonical works, authors, and cross-disciplinary integration.
- Publicly document and describe Socratic pedagogy, seminars, and memory-based recitation as a standard upper-school practice.
- Publish a formal Scholé/restful-learning framework (slow pace, contemplation days, balanced workload) as a regular element of the schedule.

- Elevate the Faculty narrative by publishing living-curriculum portraits, teacher-as-mentor language, and faculty seminars as part of the school culture.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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